Details for the
GROUP PROJECT

Purpose:

Familiarize students with the process of designing and conducting a primary research study.

This is a group project. 5-member groups will be formed, and informed to the students.

Components:

Each group has to take up a research project. They have to go through the entire research project:

a. Identify a context and a problem. It should be oriented towards the **consumers** *(as compared to business)*.
b. Define the management problem, the marketing research problem, and the research objective.
c. Convert the research objective into hypothesis/ research questions, and then into information areas.
d. Formulate a suitable research design for your study.
e. Design a qualitative study to understand the consumer opinion on the research topic. So a qualitative component should necessarily be there in the study.
f. Develop the questionnaire. So, there also has to be a quantitative component in the study.
g. Collect the data.
h. Analyze the data – to answer your research questions/ hypothesis.
i. Prepare a report for your study.

Details of Submissions

Submission 1 – Deciding the group project

Each group will submit the following –

- Background to the study
- Research problem and the context

E.g. one of the topics could be "Usage and Attitude study (U&A) for the OnePlus Mobile phones". This is a generic topic, as U&A studies involve a very wide range of topics. In the research problem part of submission, you will focus on the specific aspects that your study will focus on.

This submission will not be evaluated. The purpose is approval of your project.

Decide on your research problem	No weightage
Define the problem	

Submission 2 – Designing the Research

This submission will have the following areas:

1. State your management decision problem.
2. Convert it into marketing research problem, and then into research objective.
3. Detail the hypothesis/ research questions – the list of the issues involved in the **research topic** (or hypothesis) selected (the research questions).
4. Convert your research questions/ hypothesis into information areas.

Define the management problem, the marketing research problem, and the research objective.	Weightage: 10%
Convert the research objective into hypothesis/ research questions, and then into information areas.	

Submission 3 – Research Design

Formulate the research design	Weightage: 15%
Prepare the questionnaire	
Prepare an analysis plan	

1. Approach to the study – the **research design**. This has to be very detailed.
   It should contain a qualitative study component. You can have either Focus Groups and/or In-depth Interviews (IDP).
2. Moderator **Discussion guide** (if you are using FGD or IDP as the research technique).
   This document has the various areas that will be discussed in FGD or the IDP.
3. Results of the **qualitative study**.
4. Prepare your questionnaire. It should be a collection of the information areas listed in step 4 of your submission 2.
5. **Add questions** for segregating the respondents – to provide depth to your study.
   It should be a detailed, well-structured questionnaire – ready to be taken for data collection.
   It should NOT be cryptic, having only the questions to be asked. In such cases, I will assume that all the questions are open ended, and grade accordingly.
6. **Analysis plan** for the study.

Your report should have a clear process flow you have used to arrive at the questionnaire – Management Decision Problem → Market Research Problem → Research Objective → Research Question/ Hypothesis → Information Areas.

Please prepare the waterfall table for each research objective. It will ensure that you do not have unnecessary question in your questionnaire. And it will help you to track the specific question(s) which are answering a particular specific research question.

Research Problem Statement	Research Question A	Information Need A
		Information Need B
	Research Question B	Information Need C
		Information Need D
		Information Need E
	Research Question C	Information Need F
	Research Question D	Information Need G
		Information Need H

Submission 4 – Final Report

Field Work/ Data Collection	Weightage: 5%
Data Preparation and Analysis	
Report Writing and Presentation	

Final Report:

All the submissions taken together contribute towards the final report. This report should cover the following aspect, to be useful for the audience:

1. Background to the study
2. Problem statements – management problem statement, and the marketing research problem statement.
   Detail all the following aspects
   a. Help taken in finalizing the research problem –
   b. Any discussion with experts
   c. Any qualitative research conducted by you
   d. Secondary data research.
3. State the research questions (or hypothesis)
   Describe any model (graphical or mathematical) or framework used in this process (of converting research problem statement into research questions)
   State all the research questions (or hypothesis) being explored in the study.
4. Information needs for answer each research questions (or to test each hypothesis).
5. Questionnaire for the quantitative survey.
6. Sampling details.
7. Analysis of the data.
8. Findings.
9. Answering each and every research question.
   Answering the research problem.
   Answering the management problem.

Suggestion for Projects that you could take up

One obvious study that every group can take up is a U&A study for the context you are interested in. I will share a document on U&A study. You will realize from this document that it is a very broad canvas. Hence, each group should decide the aspects relevant to their study. This could be based on your interest areas.

A suggestion – include a component to study the **attitude of people**. For this, you will have to do an internet search and find the scales used for measuring consumer attitude. Typically, they are a battery of around 15 statements, and responses are taken on a 5-point Likert Scale (Strongly Agree to Strongly Disagree scale).

In case you are including it in your studies, and need to discuss, you can always reach me.